in St Louis in the US and one in Hong Kong. The government-run Gujarat State Non-Resident Gujaratis' Foundation lists 176 such associations within India and 120 outside. In a rare case of linguistic crossover, but perhaps it makes business sense, there is also a Gujarati-Marwari Society of Thailand.

At over 2 million each, the internal and international diaspora of the Indian Punjabis is roughly the same. But while the international diaspora is closely linked with the eastern Punjab cluster of the Great Indian Migration Wave, the internal diaspora is more widely sourced and found in key industrial hubs of the country. Of the ten major languages, it is the Tamilians and Malayalis that have a wider international diaspora than internal, although the internal diasporas are sizable—4 million and 2 million respectively. One of the routes through which the Tamilians migrated internally was through the civil services and government postings, sectors initially dominated in south India by the Tamil Brahmins, now popularly known as the Tam-Brahms. As a result, the Tamilian community in New Delhi and Mumbai runs into hundreds of thousands, where they are still sometimes referred to as the 'Madrasis', a word that originated in reference to the Madras Presidency, of which Tamil Nadu was a part. There is also a Tamil labour diaspora spread out across India, like its international counterpart. The Malayali diaspora, on the other hand, was formed by the outmigration of nurses, as well as clerks, secretaries and other administrative staff, all over India. Special training colleges for these sectors gave them an initial lead that still holds sway. In terms of the diaspora to population ratio, the Malayalis outdo all other linguistic groups of India, with a figure of over 10 per cent.

The internal diasporas of India are important to understand because they have also shaped international diasporas. Antwerp's diamond connection with Surat or West Asian oil firms' labour connection with Kerala were both channelized through Bombay because the city hosted a sizable Gujarati and Malayali diaspora. The internal diaspora also faces the same challenges of assimilation as Indians face when they move abroad. But because migration is heavily linked through social networks, assimilation need not even occur as migrants reproduce their customs and practices in